

Use the News: Reengineer Your Media Diet

LET'S REDUCE THE *noise* in your daily information diet, and help you become a less distracted, more purposeful investor. Or as Ian Cassel phrased it: "The maturation of every investor starts with absorbing almost everything and ends with filtering almost everything."¹⁰³

Addition by subtraction is where we cut out emotional, speculative nonsense. We lose huge swaths of opinion masquerading as analysis, and drop prediction-driven hype.

Media, used intelligently, can add value to your process.

Here's how.

Hold pundits accountable

The lack of accountability in financial media is detestable. All sorts of nonsense gets yelled without penalty. TV guests are rarely called out for their terrible calls or money-losing stock picks. Columnists can (and do) say anything, without fear of readers remembering their worst stuff (except for a few of us geeks).

I use a calendar to hold talking heads accountable. Someone makes a wild claim or prediction, I *diary* it. Any calendar (Google, Apple Cal, MS Outlook) will work. I also like a simple app called FollowUpThen (followupthen.com). Years later, I find out how much (or more likely how little) attention to pay these folk. I continually cull the money losers.

Create your own media research team

I have a small group of favorites I think of as my personal all-star research team. I subscribe to their Substacks and Twitter feeds, and read most of what they publish.